and useless, will become apparent of itself." Far to the west, Peter Abelard was making the same argument for dialectical inquiry: "No theory is so false," he wrote, in the *Collationes*, "that it does not contain some element of truth; no dispute is so trivial that it does not possess something that can be learned." Abelard's argument was sired by Aristotle, born of an intellectual preoccupation; Zhu Xi's, produced by more political factors. Neo-Confucianism was an adaptation of the state religion to a time when the state was frozen in place; and it spread throughout the Southern Song, becoming, perhaps, the dominant way in which the Song now understood the world.[6]

Meanwhile, the Jin were also adapting to their new condition. Jurchen tribal ways, best suited to wandering warriors, were less than useful in running a massive complicated state filled with conquered peoples and ancient cities. To keep their new empire together, the Jin modeled themselves, more and more, on the defeated enemy to the south.

In 1149, one of Akuta's grandsons led a palace revolt against the reigning Jin emperor (an unpopular drunkard growing increasingly paranoid and vicious) and seized the throne for himself. The Jin chronicles refuse to grant him an imperial name; he remains known, simply, as Prince Hailing.

Hailing was a lover of Song culture: a student of the Song lyric poems known as *ci*, an aspiring poet himself, an enthusiastic tea drinker and chess player. As soon as power was in his hands, he abolished the old honorary titles still held by the heads of the Jurchen clans, and began the decadelong process of moving the capital of the Jin out of the far northern city of Shang-ching, centered in the old Jurchen homeland, down into the cradle of ancient China: to the old city of Yanjing, which he renamed Zhongdu, the "Central Capital." He wrapped up the move by leveling the old Jurchen tribal headquarters in Shang-ching, wiping out the past.[7]

Remaking the Jin government in the image of the Song was not enough; he wanted not merely to be *like* the Song but to possess them. In 1159, with the move to Zhongdu almost complete, he began to prepare for a massive invasion: lining up half a million horses, drafting both Jurchen and Chinese into new regiments, assembling a fleet of barges to use as warships on the Yangtze. Anyone who criticized his plans, or questioned the wisdom of the invasion, was murdered.[8]

The invasion began in September of 1161 and was one-sided almost from the first battle. Hailing's patched-together sea force was outmanned and outfought by the Song navy, with its fleet of small fast attack ships and massive (up to 360 feet in length), iron-hulled, paddle-wheel war galleys, propelled by the leg power of scores of Song seamen. The Song terrified the opposition by hurling "thunderclap bombs," gunpowder and metal pellets